

PROGRAMME SCHEDULE

for

3rd Himalayan Meet of Astronomers

(HMA-III 2026)

1–3 May 2026

Venue : Seminar Hall Department of Physics
Himachal Pradesh University Shimla

First Day

Day 1:

1 May 2026 (Friday)

09:30–10:00 A.M Registration

10:00–10:30 A.M Inauguration by Prof. Mahavir Singh Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor HPU

Chair: Prof. Naseer Iqbal

Extragalactic Astronomy

Time	Name	Title
10:30–11:00	Prof. Vaidehi S. Paliya	Gamma-ray Emission from Cosmic Beacons
11:00–11:30	Prof. Hum Chand	Quasar Spectroscopy as Tool to probe Evolution of Universe

Tea Break: 11:30–11:50 A.M

Chair: Prof. Naseer Iqbal

Compact Objects

Time	Name	Title
11:50–12:20	Prof. Sakshi Gautam	Compact objects as cosmic laboratories: fundamentals, frontiers & future challenges
12:20–12:40	Sunil Kumar	Impact of Finite Temperature on the Nuclear Equation of State and Neutron Star Structure.
12:40–1:00	Mukul Kumar	Effects of Dark Matter on Neutron Star Properties: A Relativistic Mean-Field Formalism

Lunch: 1:00–2:20 P.M

Afternoon Session

Chair: Prof. Anupam Bhardwaj

Gravity/Cosmology/Fundamental Physics

Time	Name	Title
2:20–2:50	Prof. Naseer Iqbal	Statistical Physics and Cosmology
2:50–3:20	Prof. Rahul Kothari	Constraining Lorentz Violation using 21cm & CMB Cross Correlations
3:20–3:40	Bhuwan Joshi	Constraints on $f(R)$ gravity models using future radio surveys

Tea Break: 3:40–4:00 P.M

Chair: Prof. Anupam Bhardwaj

Extragalactic Astronomy

Time	Name	Title
4:00–4:20	Anshul Kumar Sharma	An Automated Photometric Pipeline for AGN Monitoring
4:20–4:40	Paryag Sharma	Investigating the Circumgalactic Medium through Mg II absorption coincidence
4:40–5:00	Priya Sharma	Probing the Circumgalactic Medium Through Various Metal Lines

Second Day

Day 2:

2 May 2026 (Saturday)

Chair: Prof. Hum Chand

Solar and Stellar Physics

Time	Name	Title
10:00–10:30	Prof. Ramesh Chandra	Advancing Solar Physics: Insights from the Uttarakhand
10:30–10:50	Asha	Study of different range of Periodicities in CMEs during Solar Cycles 23-25
10:50–11:10	Sunil Kumar	Instrument effect on damping length of Slow wave
11:10–11:30	Garima Karki	Counter-streaming Flows in a Quiescent Filament observed by THEMIS and IRIS

Tea Break: 11:30–11:50 A.M

Time	Name	Title	(Public Talk)
12:00–1:00	Prof. Anupam Bhardwaj	Our Universe's Expansion rate: A Cosmic Puzzle	

Lunch: 1:00–2:20 P.M

Afternoon Session

Chair: Prof. Vaidehi S. Paliya

Exoplanet

Time	Name	Title
2:20–2:50	Prof. Yogesh Joshi	Basics of Exoplanet Detections and Recent Advancement
2:50–3:10	Unnati Shukla	An Integrated CNN–LSTM Model for Exoplanet Transit Classification
3:10–3:30	Vishal Thakur	Comparative JWST/NIRSpec Transmission Spectroscopy of gas giants across stellar spectral types
3:30–3:45	Aryan Thakur	Modeling of Stellar flare and its impact on Exoplanet's Atmosphere using Cloudy

Tea Break: 3:45–4:05 P.M

Chair: Prof. Ramesh Chandra

Extragalactic Astronomy

Time	Name	Title
4:05–4:25	Madhu Sudan	Isolating Intrinsic Nuclear Optical Variability in Active Galaxies: Constraints from Host-Contaminated Light Curves
4:25–4:45	Niraj Kumar Sahu	VHE FSRQs: Optical-UV and X-ray Perspective
4:45–5:05	Dr. Krishan Chand	State transitions in quasars and blazars: Clues to jet-related activity
5:05–5:20	Aman Yadav	Probing Changing-Look Behaviour in Blazars through Optical Inter-band Time Lags

Third Day

Day 3:

3 May 2026 (Sunday)

Chair: Prof. Aasheesh Raturi

Solar and Stellar Physics

Time	Name	Title
10:00–10:30	Kavita Kumari	Cosmological Signature of fields beyond the Standard Model
10:30–10:50	Kamal Joshi	Study of failed filament eruptions from active region NOAA 11976
10:50–11:10	Hitesh Paliwal	Sloshing Oscillations in Coronal Loops Excited by Successive M- and C- Class Flares
11:10–11:30	Apoorv Dashora	Characteristics of two Solar Extreme-UltraViolet (EUV) waves.

Tea Break: 11:30–11:50 A.M

Chair: Prof. Yogesh Joshi

Astrophysics/Cosmology

Time	Name	Title
11:50–12:20	Prof. Aasheesh Raturi	Towards Astronomy Education Research: Perception of Teaching and Learning in Rural Himalayan Schools
12:20–12:40	Abhishek Negi	Thermodynamics and shadow constraints of slowly rotating dyonic Euler-Heisenberg black holes in a perfect fluid dark matter and plasma environment
12:40–12:55	Aryansh Saxena	Quasinormal modes of the generalized JMN naked singularity using exact WKB analysis

Lunch: 12:55–2:00 P.M

Afternoon Session

Chair: Prof. Rahul Kothari

M.Sc/Ph.D Students Talk

Time	Name	Title
2:00–2:15	Boby Verma	BAL Outflow Distance using Spectral Stacking and Photoionization
2:15–2:30	Khushi Mehta	Probing Circumgalactic Medium of Virgo Cluster Using Stacking Techniques
2:30–2:45	Upasna Manta	CIV Absorption Line Coincidence as A Probe of The Circumgalactic Medium
2:45–3:00	Sachin Pandey	Unveiling the Multi-Wavelength Nature and Jet Break Signature of GRB 210306A
3:00–3:20	Ajay Atwal	Dynamical Evolution of the Effective Equation of State parameter during Reheating in Attractor Models

Valedictory Session

(3:20 to 3:50 P.M)

Report on Himalayan Meet of Astronomers-III 2026

(Prof. Hum Chand)

Chief Guest's Address

— High Tea —